

Baptiste Larkspur

Character Dossier

Cautious, precise and haunted gardener of Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars

Overview

Baptiste Larkspur is a gardener living in Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars. Baptiste is 66 years old, originally from Kettering, and is known around Dome C as cautious, precise and haunted. In conversation Baptiste tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Background

Baptiste arrived in Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars 21 years ago after leaving Kettering under circumstances Baptiste describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Bellwether Cooperative; the second was the one that stuck. Today Baptiste works as a gardener near the water reclaimer and is paid, when paid at all, in co-op shares.

Baptiste learned the trade from Ulla Marchetti, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Baptiste's life is with Orsolya Oakhurst, over a matter neither will explain. The person Baptiste trusts most is Quentin Norwood.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: a knock at the door after dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: cautious, precise and haunted.

Speech pattern: Baptiste tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Tells: when lying, Baptiste mentions Velvet the beetle for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Baptiste Larkspur
Role	gardener
Home	Bellwether Farms, an agricultural cooperative on Mars
Hometown	Kettering
Age	66
Favourite dish	festival lentil fritters
Pet	Velvet, a beetle
Lucky number	419

<i>Workshop password</i>	obsidian-lantern
<i>Mentor</i>	Ulla Marchetti
<i>Rival</i>	Orsolya Oakhurst
<i>Closest friend</i>	Quentin Norwood

Secret

Baptiste cannot actually read the old script everyone assumes they can, and has memorised the important pages.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Baptiste: I am the gardener. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Baptiste: Festival lentil fritters. Do not tell Orsolya I said so.

Visitor: Is Velvet yours?

Baptiste: Velvet belongs to nobody. Velvet tolerates me. Lucky number is 419, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 10

Baptiste repaired the iron kettle at the water reclaimer for Nikolai, who paid in 11 co-op shares and a long story about the tax on doors. A stranger asked Baptiste for the password to the workshop. Baptiste laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Xavier came by asking about the comet. Baptiste said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 2, winter of year 10

the Bellwether Cooperative sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Baptiste read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the comet reached the rover garage. Baptiste pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Baptiste has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 3, spring of year 10

At the seed vault, Baptiste taught a newcomer how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Baptiste won 40 co-op shares on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.